Now that we have a basic understanding of behavior trees, we can move on to working with agents/assistants. Before doing that, we'll look at a tool to help us work with OpenAI Assistants. This tool will help us wrap our first ABTs around OpenAI Assistants.

6.2 Exploring the GPT Assistants Playground

For the development of this book, several GitHub projects were created to address various aspects of building agents and assistants. One such project, the GPT Assistants Playground, is built using Gradio for the interface that mimics the OpenAI Assistants Playground but with several extras added.

The Playground project was developed as both a teaching and demonstration aid. Inside the project, the Python code uses the OpenAI Assistants API to create a chat interface and an agentic system to build and power assistants. There is also a comprehensive collection of actions assistants you can use, and you can easily add your own actions.

6.2.1 Installing and running the Playground

The following listing shows installing and running the Playground project from the terminal. There is currently no PyPI package to install.

Listing 6.2 Installing the GPT Assistants Playground

```
# change to a working folder and create a new Python virtual environment
git clone
↪ https://github.com/cxbxmxcx/GPTAssistantsPlayground     #1
cd GPTAssistantsPlayground      #2
pip install -r requirements.txt      #3
```

#1 Pulls the source code from GitHub
#2 Changes directory to the project source code folder
#3 Installs the requirements

You can run the application from the terminal or using Visual Studio Code (VS Code), with the latter giving you more control. Before running the application, you need to set your OpenAI API key through the command line or by creating an `.env` file, as we've done a few times already. Listing 6.3 shows an example of setting the environment variable on Linux/Mac or the Git Bash shell (Windows recommended) and running the application.